SEND WITH THE SCRIPT

Self-recording guide

Reality-TV confessional style: you sit and talk to the camera, deadpan. No interviewer, so prop up your own phone, or let whoever sent you this hold it, and record it in five minutes whenever you have a free moment.

Setup

- **Nobody films you.** Prop your phone horizontal against a stack of books or a mug, at face height, about an arm's length away. Sit in a chair against a plain wall or a bookshelf.
- **Light:** face a window or a lamp. Don't sit with a window behind you.
- **Eyeline:** look just to the side of the lens, as if a producer is sitting next to the phone. Glancing at the lens once or twice is fine.
- **Tone:** deadpan beats hammy. You are a sincere person who has nothing to hide and is slightly annoyed to be asked.

Recording

- **The script:** read it from a second screen or a printout taped just under the phone. The *(beat)* and *(pause)* marks are where the laughs live. Hold them longer than feels natural.
- **Takes:** two max. Send the slightly flubbed one. Don't edit anything.
- **Length:** 60 to 90 seconds. Start recording, wait two seconds, begin. Stop two seconds after the last line.
- **Send it:** text or AirDrop the raw video to whoever sent you the script. They add the title card and load it onto the classroom laptop.

Making the script yours

Words in [brackets] are adjustable. The facts the kids check (shoe size, where you were, what you wore, how you feel about squishies) live on your **Suspect Statement form**, not in this video; your answer card tells you what to write there. The box at the top of your script lists the one or two things the video has to agree with, and the lines you should keep word for word. Everything else is flavor. Swap in your real life, your real subject, your real habits. Wear whatever you like. True details get the biggest laughs.

The ask (email or text to each suspect)

Subject: 5 minutes of acting for the 4th grade Halloween party?

Hi [Name],

Mrs. Driscoll's class Halloween party on Oct 30 is a whodunit, and the kids are going to investigate four staff "suspects." Would you be one of the three who record a statement? All it takes is a 90-second video of yourself that you can record alone on your phone whenever you have a free minute. No one films you, no one edits you, and you don't need to attend the party.

Attached are your script and a one-page Suspect Statement form with an answer card. Four answers on the form are scripted so the kids' clues line up; the rest is yours, and true is funnier. The video is a monologue, so just talk to the camera. Quick tips:
• Phone horizontal, propped at face height, plain wall behind you
• Look just beside the lens, like a producer is sitting there
• Deadpan. Sincere. Slightly annoyed to be asked.
• Hold the pauses. Two takes max. Send me the raw video and the filled-in form by [Oct 23].

The kids will watch it on the projector during the party and, I promise, lose their minds. Thank you!

[Your name] · [room parent for Mrs. Driscoll's class] · [phone]

The Custodian gets a different ask: "You're a suspect who declined to comment. That's it. That's the whole job. Please act shifty in the hallway on Oct 30."

VIDEO 3 · PLAYS AFTER STATION 3

VIDEO 3 — THE LIBRARIAN

self-recorded monologue, ~75 sec, WHISPERED throughout · Zero information, whispered throughout. Accidentally sounds guilty three times.

TITLE CARD · INTERVIEW 3 · THE LIBRARIAN · 12:30 PM

MAKE IT YOURS (read before you record)

- Your facts live on your Suspect Statement form (answer card attached). On camera, two things have to agree with it: you were in the building at [2:15] (your [2:00 to 2:30] shelving window has to include it), and you love squishies. Your shoe size is on the form and it is what clears you, so don't say a number on camera. Wear whatever you like.
- Free to change: [shelving] (any solo task you really do), [on every cart], why it's stressful, [alphabetized] (any librarian joke you like better).
- Keep exactly: "Whoever took them… check their feet." It points the kids at the footprint clue.

Words in [brackets] are yours to adjust. Say them naturally, without the brackets.

(Sit. Whisper the entire thing, as if you're still in the library. Look just beside the camera.)

(whispering) I know I don't have to whisper. It's a habit.

Where was I at [2:15] yesterday? [Shelving]. I [shelve] from [2:00 to 2:30] every day. Alone. In the back. With no witnesses.

(pause)

That sounded worse than I meant it to.

Did I see anyone near Mrs. Driscoll's room? I saw someone in the hallway. Moving quickly. Carrying something. Hugging it, actually. Like a puppy.

(beat. Close your eyes.)

…I also hug things. Books, mostly.

(pause)

Do I like squishies? I love squishies. I have a squishy [on every cart]. They're very good for stress. [Shelving] is stressful. People put books back in the wrong place on purpose.

(beat. Realize how all of that sounded.)

So, to summarize: I had motive, I had access, and I hug things.

(long pause)

I'd like to amend my earlier statements.

(beat)

No. I did not take the squishies. But if I had, they would be [alphabetized] by now.

(lean in toward the camera, whisper even quieter)

One more thing for the detectives. Whoever took them… check their feet.

(sit back)

I don't know why I said that. I just felt like a detective would say that.

(Stand, push the chair in silently, walk out of frame. Stop recording.)

ANSWER CARD · THE LIBRARIAN

Your Suspect Statement: what to write

Fill out the attached form in your own handwriting. The four answers marked ★ are scripted, because the detectives check them against printed evidence: copy those exactly. The rest are suggestions; write anything you like, and true is funnier. Hand the form back to whoever sent you this by [Oct 23], with your video.

★ **1. Where were you at 2:15?**	Shelving. Alone. In the back. 2:00 to 2:30, every day.
2. Who can confirm that?	No witnesses. That sounded worse than I meant it to.
★ **3. Shoe size**	7
★ **4. What were you wearing?**	My orange cardigan.
★ **5. Squishies?**	Tick LOVE THEM. Explain: “One on every cart. Shelving is stressful.”
6. Inside Mrs. Driscoll's room?	Tick YES. Add: “Overdue books.”
7. Did you take the Jar?	No. If I had, they would be alphabetized by now.
8. Anything else?	Whoever took them... check their feet.

Why these answers: Your shoe size is what clears you (Clue 1, the footprint is a 10). Write 7 whatever your real size is.

SUSPECT STATEMENT

OFFICIAL

MRS. DRISCOLL'S DETECTIVE BUREAU · CASE #1031 · FORM S-3

Suspect Statement

Answer every question. Print clearly. This will be read by detectives aged nine and ten. They notice everything.

Name _____

Job at this school The Librarian

1. Where were you yesterday at 2:15 PM?

_____

_____

2. Who can confirm that?

_____

3. Shoe size (we will check) _____

4. What were you wearing yesterday? Color counts. _____

5. Squishies. How do you feel about them?

☐ Love them ☐ Don't get them ☐ What is a squishy?

_____

6. Have you ever been inside Mrs. Driscoll's room?

☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Define "inside" _____

7. Did you take the Jar?

_____

8. Anything else the detectives should know?

_____

_____

_____

Signature _____

Date _____

OFFICIAL USE ONLY

Cleared by: ☐ Clue 1 footprint ☐ Clue 2 timeline ☐ Clue 3 orange sweater ☐ Clue 4 witness